

this, but we felt pretty good after we put completed our hate profile. While we are not recommending dumping Facebook and Orkut, Hatebook is always an option for those crappy days of the month when you are apt to burst a vein.

SHARE AND DIE

RIAA Trouble

The RIAA recently saw a major victory in its attempts to clamp down on music pirates: a court fined 30-year-old Jammie Thomas \$222,000 (Rs 8.8 crore) for illegally uploading 24 songs. At \$9,250 a song, Ms Thomas will have to pay a gorgeous penny—if appeals to the verdict fall through.

The ruling has undoubtedly warmed the hearts of copyright Nazis, leaving file sharers fuming. But we aren't talking about the implications or the legalities here; we're only going to point out how a bad lawyer can chuck you from the frying pan into the fire.

Dietary Fibre

Jayesh, the quietest, most deserving member of our team, this month got what he deserved: a trip to Taiwan. Quite the *desi* at heart, here's all he had to say: "It looks like a quiet Nariman Point—a few tall buildings here and there." (N. P. is where one sees buildings tall by Indian standards.) Now all the while he was there, Rossi was complaining so loud about *his* deserving to go, Ed shut him up by slapping a cricket bat upon his head. Later, filled with remorse, he wept: "I'm sorry, Rossi, for having caused you potential death! Go to Taiwan, go, go, go! Here's \$2.50 from my own pocket!" (Ajwani.)

And thus it came to pass: two trips across the oceans (or land, at any rate) in a month. Now here's the ghastly part: J and R both now have a contempt for Indian food. Whereas J has taken a

liking to tubifex worms, R's cuisine of choice involves lizard garnished with bat wing. (Actually, it was predictable: Jayesh is always in office by 9, and the early bird catches the worm—see?) Interestingly, as a result of the unavailability of aforementioned ingredients, they are both to be seen walking in a pair on the street, eyeing fat street dogs. We're hoping it's a passing phase.

Meanwhile, news is out that we're moving to a place called just "CBD," where Bhaskar, Michael, Ram, and Samir stay. They're all happy, naturally, but Ram is actually elated because he can now have a proper siesta every day, as opposed to curling up under his desk pretending he isn't there.

Digit does not guarantee the accuracy of any of the information presented above. No libel claims, please—worms are rich in fibre.

DIGIT DIARY

After the RIAA's investigators had hauled Ms Thomas in front of the jury, her lawyer mounted arguments which even a self-proclaimed computer-illiterate jury member found laughable. The prosecution showed that the IP address used to upload the music files to KaZaa matched Thomas' computer, and her attorney speculated that a hacker with a laptop outside her apartment could be

responsible. A credible argument, if only Thomas had used a wireless router to do the uploading. Expert evidence debunked the hand of Wi-Fi, and the attorney was left looking like a sad fool. The second mistake Ms Thomas made was when she handed over a different hard disk to the investigators when asked for the one containing the offending files. A *third* mistake was that her username at KaZaa

tallied with her e-mail, MySpace, and online shopping logins. By this point, the jury members were insulted by the shenanigans of the defence counsel, who obviously thought them a bunch of hillbillies. And when that happens, you'll catch hell.

Only two pieces of advice to the sad Ms Thomas—get a smarter lawyer next time. And a new username. ☒

Blog WATCH

Serious issues this month. What's the connection between social networking and large portals? Then, the OLPC project still runs strong in blogging circles... and then, what's gotten into the head of the Chinese government?

Steve Rubel: *How the Portals Will Win the Social Networking Wars*

<http://www.micropersuasion.com/2007/10/how-the-portals.html> (<http://tinyurl.com/2ze3l7>)

Social networking is certainly rising and there seems to be no end in sight to the phenomenon. However, what I do know is that people will jump around from one Myfaceborkutspace to another and not all of them will win. This is particularly going to be true as social networking evolves from a destination into a feature of every site. What does this have to do with the portals?

...No matter which social network(s) you participate in, you're going to turn to your trusted communication system to manage it all. This will include any or all of the following: a) web-based e-mail, b) instant messaging, c) RSS and d) telephony tools like Grand Central. And who dominates those?

Seth Godin: *This changes everything*

http://sethgodin.typepad.com/seths_blog/2007/10/this-changes-ev.html (<http://tinyurl.com/ysmefh>)

Never mind the buy 1 give 1 (a great idea). Don't wait until November when you can directly buy laptops for kids right here: One Laptop Per Child -- XO Giving. I just bought five. (Hit the Donate button.)

When you give a kid a net connection, access to wikipedia and to the rest of the world, things change

fast. Things you wouldn't necessarily predict. Like a ten year old who can diagnose his dad's illness. Or a farmer that can ask his daughter to find out where to get a new part for the tractor. Or...

The bravery: When Nicholas Negroponte and his team started this project, they had nothing but obstacles. The status quo of software and hardware and skeptics stood firmly in his way. And he took a lot of grief for the effort. Even when you're doing nothing but good, fear of change is going to cause a lot of people to object.

Duncan Riley: *China Declares War On Western Search Sites*

www.techcrunch.com/2007/10/18/cyberwar-china-declares-war-on-western-search-sites/ (<http://tinyurl.com/yuavds>)

If the Chinese Government were serious about censorship alone, we would have reports of page not found, not redirects to Baidu. It is clearly using its censorship regime to the economic benefit of a Chinese owned (but NASDAQ listed) company. Although the US Government is a poor WTO member, given that China is a recent member, the US Government should lodge a complaint with the WTO. China expects free and open access to Western nations but is now not only blocking, but also redirecting domestic traffic away from Western internet sites that compete with local firms.